Who should pick this up? - complete text version

Follow work across the complete B2B sales team. Match each scenario to the role that should lead it: sales development representative, account executive, solution architect or customer success manager. Then choose two items for a priority plan, inspect the handovers you leave uncovered, and revise when the priority changes. Choose a priority. For every work item, select the role that should lead it and decide whether to include it in your two-item plan. Review the plan, revise any gaps, then try a changed priority. Finish by writing and saving a short rationale. Allow about 5–7 minutes. For this planning exercise, your plan has two task slots. This is an exercise constraint, not an estimate of task duration or a rule for a real working day. Choose the role that should lead each scenario. Other roles may support the work in practice, but one role owns the next action at this point in the customer journey.

How to use this version

On paper or in a document, choose one priority below. Match all four tasks to an outcome, then select two tasks for your plan. Compare your matches with the feedback. Use the selection guide to check capacity and coverage. Revise, then switch to the next priority and repeat. Write your rationale using the prompt at the end. This follows the same decisions as the interactive version.

Choose a priority

Turn interest into a qualified opportunity

Your plan must cover the SDR-to-AE handover.

Confirm commercial and technical fit

Your plan must cover the AE working with the solution architect.

Move from solution fit to successful adoption

Your plan must cover the solution architect-to-CSM handover.

Match and select tasks

For each work item, choose the role that should lead it. Separately, choose whether to include it in the plan or leave it for later. Match every item, including those left for later.

Qualify a new lead

A new contact is interested in Jin Cloud Solutions. Research the company, make first contact and check whether there is genuine interest, a suitable budget and decision-making authority before a handover.

- Sales development representative (SDR): This is the most direct match: the SDR researches, contacts and qualifies the lead before handover.
- Account executive (AE): The account executive takes over once the opportunity is qualified. This item is still at the SDR stage.
- Solution architect (SA): Technical design comes later. The immediate need is to decide whether this lead is worth pursuing.
- Customer success manager (CSM): Customer success works after the sale. This contact has not yet become a qualified opportunity.

Most direct match: Sales development representative (SDR). The SDR owns the front of the pipeline: finding, nurturing and qualifying potential customers before handing a real opportunity to the account executive.

Shape the commercial opportunity

A qualified prospect needs deeper discovery. Clarify its security needs, compliance requirements, budget and timeline, then turn those findings into a proposal and negotiate the agreement.

- Sales development representative (SDR): The lead is already qualified. The SDR hands it over rather than owning proposal and negotiation.
- Account executive (AE): This is the most direct match: the account executive leads discovery, the proposal and the commercial agreement.
- Solution architect (SA): The solution architect supports technical fit, but the account executive owns the commercial opportunity.
- Customer success manager (CSM): Customer success takes responsibility after the sale, not during proposal and negotiation.

Most direct match: Account executive (AE). The account executive owns the qualified commercial opportunity: discovery, the business case, the proposal and negotiation, bringing in specialist support when needed.

Design the technical fit

The prospect needs the proposed cloud platform to integrate with existing systems and meet security and compliance requirements. Assess feasibility and translate the needs into a clear technical roadmap.

- Sales development representative (SDR): The lead is well beyond qualification. This item needs technical expertise rather than SDR ownership.

- Account executive (AE): The account executive owns the deal and works alongside this role, but the technical roadmap belongs to the solution architect.
- Solution architect (SA): This is the most direct match: the solution architect assesses feasibility and designs the technical fit.
- Customer success manager (CSM): Customer success may help after deployment, but the solution is still being designed before the sale.

Most direct match: Solution architect (SA). The solution architect owns technical fit: assessing requirements, shaping the solution and explaining how it will work securely with the customer's systems.

Drive adoption and value

The contract is signed and the solution has been deployed. Guide the customer's team through onboarding and training, monitor usage, resolve adoption issues and identify ways to increase long-term value.

- Sales development representative (SDR): This is now a customer, not a lead. The SDR's qualification work finished before the sale.
- Account executive (AE): The commercial agreement is signed. The account executive hands the customer into post-sale success.
- Solution architect (SA): The solution architect may support technical issues, but ongoing adoption and value are owned by customer success.
- Customer success manager (CSM): This is the most direct match: the customer success manager leads onboarding, adoption and long-term value.

Most direct match: Customer success manager (CSM). The customer success manager owns the post-sale relationship: onboarding, adoption, value realisation, renewals and opportunities to deepen the partnership.

Review rules

Choose an outcome for every task, including tasks left for later. Revise the task–outcome links using the feedback below. All four work items are matched to the role that should lead them. The plan exceeds the two-task limit. Leave a task for later and review the effect on coverage. The plan has unused space. Choose two tasks and review their contributions. The plan fits the two-task limit. Both roles needed for this priority are represented. This plan meets the exercise constraints. Explain what it supports and what you defer. Revise the plan and review again. You can change any match or task selection. Your plan has changed. Review it again to update the feedback. Check outcome coverage using the tasks themselves, even if you matched them incorrectly. A viable plan needs all four matches revised, exactly two tasks selected, and direct support for both priority outcomes. The guide below covers every possible selection. For each priority, a listed gap means those outcomes have no selected task; no gaps means both outcomes have support.

Every possible task selection

Include: None

The plan has unused space. Choose two tasks and review their contributions. Tasks left for later: Qualify a new lead; Shape the commercial opportunity; Design the technical fit; Drive adoption and value

- Turn interest into a qualified opportunity: Roles missing from this priority plan: Sales development representative (SDR); Account executive (AE).
- Confirm commercial and technical fit: Roles missing from this priority plan: Account executive (AE); Solution architect (SA).
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Include: Qualify a new lead; Shape the commercial opportunity; Design the technical fit; Drive adoption and value

The plan exceeds the two-task limit. Leave a task for later and review the effect on coverage. Tasks left for later: None.

- Turn interest into a qualified opportunity: Both roles needed for this priority are represented.
- Confirm commercial and technical fit: Both roles needed for this priority are represented.
- Move from solution fit to successful adoption: Both roles needed for this priority are represented.

Change the priority and revise

The priority has changed. Your task choices are kept. Review the same plan, then revise it for the new outcomes. Choose a priority different from your first reviewed plan and change which tasks you include. Review the revised plan before saving. Move from the first priority to the second, from the second to the third, or from the third back to the first. Keep your task selection for an initial review, then revise. Keep every task–outcome link: changing the priority changes which work you select, not the contribution of each task.

Save your rationale

Explain why each selected role should lead its work item, how the handover fits the priority and what you leave for later. Use only the fictional case; do not enter personal or customer information. Write the priority, the two selected tasks with their outcome links, the tasks left for later, and your rationale. In the interactive version, Save my plan downloads these as a text file after you review a viable plan for a changed priority. An empty rationale prompts: Write a short rationale before saving. Start again clears your choices so you can repeat the exercise. You have routed work across all four sales-team roles and revised a plan for a changed handover priority.